BUSH FIRE OPERATING PROCEDURE

City of Armadale Brigade (~~Deputies and Rangers~~– 9002
Bedfordale Volunteer Bush Fire Brigade – 6040
Roleystone Volunteer Bush Fire Brigade - 6560

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1. BUSH FIRE OPERATING PROCEDURE

These procedures and guidelines have been developed for the safety and efficient operation of the City of Armadale (CoA) Bushfire Brigades.

These Procedures are a living document adopted by the Chief Bush Fire Control Officer as amended from time to time, as required

Input from Brigade members is welcome and should a Brigade memberfeel that a Procedure is unworkable, not practical or needs inclusion they should raise the matter at their local Brigade meeting, this then can be discussed at the Executive Management Committee meetings.

Objectives

The Brigades have the following objectives—

- To undertake bush fire brigade operations.
- To prevent, control and suppress fires in the local government area/region.
- To protect life, property and the environment in emergencies occurring in the local government area/region.
- To provide a means by which persons may participate in the activities of the Brigade at a local level.
- To ensure that Brigade members are properly trained for bush fire brigade operations.
- To perform any other function assigned to the Brigade by the CBFCO under the Act, or the Regulations.
- To assist and co-operate with all state and local emergency services.
- To encourage and foster public awareness of the dangers of bush fires, and actively promote bush fire prevention measures to the public and landowners of the district.

2. DEFINITIONS

In these procedures, unless the context otherwise requires –

"Act" means the *Bush Fires Act 1954*
"BVBFB" means the Bedfordale Volunteer Bush Fire Brigade
"CBFCO" means the Chief Bush Fire Control Officer
"CESC" means the Community Emergency Services Coordinator
Local Government means the City of Armadale
"COMCEN" means the DFES Communications Centre
"DCBFCO" means Deputy Chief Bush Fire Control Officer
"DFES" means the Department of Fire and Emergency Services
"Emergency vehicle" means a vehicle **Road Traffic Code 2000 - Terms & abbreviations used**

Commented [CV1]: Shouldn't this read that the information contained in this document is to be overseen by the COA and CBFCO on advise and recommendation provided by the VBFB and Executive Committee?

Commented [CV2]: Shouldn't this refer to the brigade management committee for discussion at the Executive Committee?

Commented [CV3]: Isn't this covered by the Local Law and Section 35A of the BFA? Wouldn't this just add confusion? No I don't think so

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(a) when conveying a police officer on official duty or when that vehicle is stationary at any place connected with the official duty; or

(b) of a fire brigade on official duty in consequence of a fire or an alarm of fire or of an emergency or rescue operation where human life or property is reasonably considered to be in danger; or

(c) being an ambulance, answering an urgent call or conveying any injured or sick person to any place for the provision of urgent treatment.

"Procedure" means the Bush Fire Operating Procedures
"Roleystone" means the Roleystone Volunteer Bush Fire Brigade
"Unexploded Ordanance" means unexploded bombs

3. MEMBERSHIP REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Conditions of Membership

- A person applying to join a Brigade must attend a minimum of 3 consecutive ordinary meetings of that Brigade.
- The applicant may be required to obtain a medical clearance from one of CoA nominated doctors at CoA cost.
- The applicant will then be eligible for basic fire fighter training.

The Brigade Officer Committee, at their meeting may vary the following requirements:

- The requirement to serve a probationary period and determine its length, being not more than 12 months.
- Any additional requirements. Such requirements may include, but are not limited to, a National Police clearance.

Commented [CV5]: Doesn't this contradict the Rules? Part 2 of the rules cover this.

3.2 Skills Maintenance

To remain a fire fighting member, Brigade members must maintain proficiency and currency of skills relevant to their role. To ensure this outcome, this Procedure empowers the CoA to establish policies and procedures in support of this document.

Commented [CV6]: Isn't this covered by the Rules? Part 2

3.3 Brigade Commitments

- Brigade members shall attend a minimum of one ordinary meeting of their Brigade every three months.
- Brigade members shall attend and participate in two brigade training sessions every three months.
- Brigades conduct activities of many types. These may include –
  - Emergency response.
  - Hazard reduction.
  - Public relations and education.
  - Fundraising.
  - Brigade maintenance.
  - Public service.

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Commented [CV7]: This is a decision of the Brigade Committee not the CBFCO or the Local Governement. Covered by Part 2 of the Rules

3.4 Failure to Meet Commitments

Should a member fail to comply with the requirements set out in this document, correspondence will be forwarded to that member requesting contact be made with the Brigade Officer Committee to indicate the intentions of the firefighting member's status.

The Brigade member may—

- Respond to the correspondence providing a reasonable explanation and request for alternative arrangements to be made for training or meeting obligations;
- Request leave of absence from Brigade commitments due to personal circumstances; or
- Terminate their membership.

If a Brigade member fails to respond to the correspondence within 14 days a subsequent letter will be forwarded from the Brigade Officer Committee putting the Brigade member on final notice. Should a Brigade member fail to acknowledge the final notice within 14 days, their membership shall be terminated and a letter shall be sent to that member giving 7 days to return all CoA owned equipment. If equipment hasn't been returned within 7 days an invoice will be sent to that member. The termination will take effect from the date of the final notice.

3.5 Management Positions

A member must not hold a management position i.e. FCO, Captain, Lieutenant, Secretary, Treasurer, Equipment Officer or Training Officer with more than one brigade.

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13.3. COMMITTEES

A. Executive Management Committee

B. The purpose of the City of Armadale (CoA) Bushfire Brigade Executive Management Committee (EMC) is to discuss strategic directions, operational requirements and future planning of the CoA emergency services. The EMC shall meet no less than 6 times per year.

The Executive Management Committee is appointed by the CoA and will meet on a regular basis, and should hold not less than six meetings a year.
The Executive Management Committee will consist of the following officers from all Brigades of the CoA Fire Services—

- CESC.
- CBFCO and Deputies.
- Executive Management Committee Secretary (no voting rights).
- Brigade Captains.
- 1st Lieutenant from each Brigade.
- Local Government Fire Training Coordinator (if implemented).
- Any other person that the Executive Management Committee requests.

In the absence of the Captain or 1st Lieutenant, the next available senior Lieutenant may attend in their place.

The Executive Management Committee will be responsible for the general management, administrative and policy affairs of the CoA Fire Service.

Any of the functions of a Brigade may be delegated to the Executive Management Committee provided a motion authorising the delegation is carried at an ordinary or annual general meeting of the Brigade.

The CBFCO will preside at a meeting of the Executive Management Committee. In the absence of the CBFCO a Deputy CBFCO will preside.

If the CBFCO and the Deputy CBFCO are not present or a quorum is not present then the meeting shall be cancelled or deferred.

Five members shall constitute a quorum of the Executive Management Committee.

A decision carried by the votes of a majority present at a meeting of the Executive Management Committee is a decision of the Executive Management Committee.

Each voting member present at a meeting of the Executive Management Committee is entitled to one vote on a matter arising for decision. The person presiding at the meeting will have, in the event of an equality of votes, a second vote.

Commented [CV9]: Please insert a Terms of Reference for this committee.

~~The Brigade Officer Committee will not exercise any of the roles or responsibilities of the Executive Management Committee.~~

~~A Brigade may delegate any decision of the Brigade to the Brigade Officers Committee by passing a motion to that effect.~~

Commented [CV10]: Covered by the Local Law and Rules

Commented [NP11]: This is already in the local law - Rules

C. Training Officer Committee

The Training Committee is responsible for—

- Coordinating training delivery to the Brigades.
- Advising the Brigade Officer Committee on matters of policy relating to training.
- The Training Officer Committee consists of the Training Officers from each brigade, Local Government Training Coordinator if appointed and CBFCO.

The Training Committee will meet as often as required.

14.4. BASIC TRAINING

Brigade members are required to successfully complete the minimum training required including Introduction to Firefighting, Bush Fire Firefighting and AIIMS Awareness and as well as the probationary firefighter Log Book. No probationary fire fighter may undertake any fire combat role before successfully completing this training and being signed off by your nominated person.

15.5. ADVANCED TRAINING

Brigade members may nominate for further training courses as they become available. These nominations will be considered by the Brigade Officer Committee, which may approve or reject such nominations. All approved nominations will be prioritised before being forwarded to DFES, as per current DFES requirements. The CoA may exercise the right

of final say.
Approval and priority will be based on the following—

- Any prerequisites in terms of training, experience or length of service. Any such prerequisites may be imposed by DFES, the CoA or current Brigade policy.
- The requirements and responsibilities of the Brigade.
- Suitability of the nominee for the course in question and/or the role(s) the nominee may be qualified to fill subsequent to the course.

16.6. FITNESS FOR ACTIVE DUTY/INJURIES/HEALTH

All active members are required to be fit for work at all times. The COA recognises that an individual's fitness for work may be affected for a variety of reasons, including the adverse effects of fatigue, stress, injury / illness, alcohol or drugs (over the counter, prescription or illicit). These factors can lead to major deficiencies in an individual's work performance and can be a contributing factor in workplace accidents.

The COA Fitness for Work procedure provides a framework for dealing with these difficult and often sensitive issues. The Brigade believes that early intervention strategies can assist individuals to address a difficult situation, which may otherwise place at risk, their safety and health and adversely affect the safety and health of other persons.

"Fit for Work" means an individual is in a state (physically, mentally and behaviorally) which enables the volunteer to perform assigned tasks competently and in a manner which does not compromise or threaten the safety or health of themselves or others.

Final determination of "Fit for Work" is based on the opinion of the CBFCO, or other appropriate persons representing management, and in conjunction with additional assessment procedures and following due consultation with the member.

Injuries – Duty of Care

The CoA has a duty of care to provide and maintain a safe working environment and to ensure volunteers are not exposed to hazards. Members also have a duty of care to notify the Brigade Captain of any pre-existing injuries or illness, including worker's compensation. This information is to ensure that a member's assigned role can be carried out without risk or harm to themselves or others.

If a member is injured or has a medical condition (including worker's compensation) a medical certificate is to be produced.
Members will be stood down from active service until a medical practitioner has cleared the person fully fit to return to active duties.

17.7. CALL OUTS

Generally, all call outs are by Pager or SMS. Unless otherwise stated, all calls are to be treated as an emergency call.
All responses are to be under lights and sirens unless otherwise notified via telephone/radio or sms.

PROCEDURE

a) Notification/Response to pager calls

Pager calls are to be acknowledged within 2 minutes by phone advising the call has been received and crews will be mobile shortly. Once crews are turning out contact COMCEN and advise.

b) Fire call availability/Response

When a pager call/SMS message is received requesting additional crews, DO NOT automatically attend the Fire Station assuming that attendance is required at a fire. Contact your Captain or the author of the message in the first instance notifying of your availability. A list of available fire fighters will be compiled and personnel allocated to various vehicles, depending on status (Crew Leader, HR and MR licence holders, Probationary members, etc.).

c) Rosters

Personal who have been placed on roster have priority over all other personal when responding to incidents.

18.8. DRIVING GUIDELINES FOR BUSH FIRE BRIGADES

Driving emergency vehicles under emergency conditions brings with it an added responsibility to the Officer in Charge and the driver of the vehicle. The driver must hold the PUAVEH001A or B Drive Vehicles under Emergency Conditions qualification or have completed the DFES on road driver training, non-qualified persons are not permitted to drive under emergency conditions unless authorized by the CBFCO to do so. The safety of the community at large should be balanced with the urgency of the call at all times.

Drivers should, in the first instance ensure the safety of the crew and the public when responding to a call, and secondly endeavour to arrive at the incident as soon as practicable.

Drivers should follow the principles outlined in this Bush Fire Operating Procedure. No risk is justified if it is likely to prejudice the safe arrival of the appliance and crews at an incident or the safety of others within the community.

Driving an emergency vehicle under emergency conditions comes with a set of responsibilities that may have dire consequences if they are not performed rationally, competently, professionally and with consideration for others (road users, pedestrians etc.).

PROCEDURE

a) Driving Conditions for Bush Fire Brigade Personnel

All drivers must hold a valid and current class of driving license for the vehicle type that is being driven.

All drivers must have the approval of the brigade Captain to drive the vehicle and where possible complete COA or DFES approved course for the appropriate class of vehicle.

Drivers holding "P" Plates may drive appliances as part of driver training; however are not to drive to or at emergencyincidents or during fire operations.
Drivers are not to operate fire appliances for longer than a 12-hour shift.

b) Drivers Licence

The Brigade has a duty of care to ensure personnel are qualified to operate vehicles and licences are appropriate and current, the duty also extends to the safety of passengers riding in vehicles.

Members will require an LR (Light Rigid), MR (Medium Rigid) or HR (Heavy Rigid) driving licence when operating the larger appliances such as a 1.4, 2.4, 3.4 or 4.4, communication with the Brigade Officers will verify appropriate licence required. **Probationary drivers are not to drive vehicles under emergency conditions.**

Commented [NP12]: I would put in here what they are.

Members may be required to complete 10 hours of on-road driving and 10 hours off-road driving (4WD vehicles) under instruction before the Brigade Management Team approves the member as a qualified driver/operator. Whilst under instruction, the vehicle will proceed under normal road conditions to an incident (no lights and no sirens). This may be at the discretion of the CBFCO.

It is a requirement that all members produce their current Drivers Licence once a year at a nominated Brigade meeting, or at any other time at the CBFCOs or Captains request.

Members unable to attend the nominated meeting may email a scanned copy of their current licence (front and back) in addition to a copy of the Online Licence Check http://www.transport.wa.gov.au/licensing/drivers-licence-check-online.asp to show that your licence Status is Active. CBFCO or Captain my request a copy of this at any time.

Personal who's licence becomes invalid must notify the CBFCO & Captain within 3 days of this occurring.

Noncompliance will result in members being ineligible to drive any CoA Fire Service vehicle until their status has been verified or reinstated .

c) Fire Call Conditions

Appliances responding with haste where Life/Property is in danger **MUST NOT EXCEED 20kms** over the speed limit.

Emergency Warning Beacons, SIREN and headlights are to be on at all times when travelling to an Operational Emergency incident or at the discretion of the OIC Officer in Charge or Crew Leader.

Commented [NP13]: Definition

Rail crossing signals, boom gates, road works and school zones to be obeyed at ALL times.

Approach traffic control signals or stop signs at a speed which will enable you to bring the vehicle to a complete stop if necessary prior to entering the intersecting carriageway, and the driver shall not continue their course unless they are satisfied that it is safe to do so. Drivers under emergency conditions cannot force other road users to contravene the *Road Traffic Act 1974* e.g. force them to go through red lights.

d) Normal Road Conditions

When returning to the fire station, attending training or exercises and general operations
NO emergency warning lights and sirens are to be used. **ALL** road rules must be obeyed at **ALL** times.

e) Driving Requirements for Off-road Use

When driving off road on the fire ground in boggy conditions the vehicle is to be operated in low range 4X4 at all times. This reduces the risk of burning the clutch out.

Should the appliance become disabled (bogged) stop and immediately assess the situation. If able to, attempt to recover vehicle no more than three times. If unsuccessful request assistance immediately and stay with vehicle. CoA can arrange recovery if required.

Hubs on vehicles with freewheeling hubs are to be locked in at all times.

Speed is to be minimised to ensure safety of occupants.

f) General

- Fire Fighters must at all times, drive with due care and attention and continue to show consideration to other road users.
- It is essential that the privileges granted by law are not abused.
- Crew care and safety must be ensured at all times when driving.
- Warning lights are to be in operation at all times when working off the appliance.
- Brigade units are not to be used other than for call outs or normal brigade activities as defined in the *Bush Fires Act 1954* or unless otherwise authorized by the CBFCO. This is to ensure adherence with insurance obligations.

10. TRUCK (APPLIANCE) MAINTENANCE

It is the responsibility of the Crew Leader and his crew to complete the appliance power check on the appliance after returning it to the station. The appliance is to be cleaned inside and out and left for the next crew as required. Any faults are to be recorded on the white board and the Equipment Officer notified.

Vehicle log books (if available) must be completed by the driver every time the vehicle is used.

11. VEHICLE & EQUIPMENT MAINTENANCE DAYS

Each Brigade holds a vehicle and equipment maintenance day once a month to which.members are required to attend. All faults should be noted and reported to the Brigade equipment officer.

12. PERSONAL PROTECTIVE EQUIPMENT

a) Standard of Dress for all Fire Fighting Personnel WILL BE:

Registered Brigade Personnel on the fire ground must be dressed in accordance with the DFES recommended industry standard or equivalent. Personnel turning up to fires without the minimum requirement (including the wearing of helmets) will be advised to leave the fire ground until such time as they comply with the standards.

b) Recommended Standard for Bush Fire Fighting - Personal Protective Clothing (PPC)



- Approved Coveralls (one or two piece)
- Approved Helmet
- Face Mask
- Fire fighting Boots
- Gloves and Goggles

Only correctly attired personnel will be permitted to crew Brigade appliances.

The Personal Protective Clothing kit remains the property of the CoA Fire Services at all times. Upon resignation or termination from the Brigade, all kits must be returned to the CBFCO for cleaning. The CBFCO may re-issue to other active or new members. Failure to return the kit to the Brigade will result in the issue of an invoice for the replacement cost of a new PPE kit.
Failure to pay or return the issued gear may result in legal action being undertaken by the CoA to recover the items or the outstanding debt.
All members are responsible for the availability, care, cleanliness and maintenance of all PPE issued to them.

c) Equivalent Standard

An equivalent standard is cotton or woolen long trousers, cotton or woolen long sleeve shirt and safety boots and leather gloves for non-brigade members.

d) Dress Uniforms

Dress uniforms worn at official functions must be clean and ironed and be worn in a professional manor as you are representing the CoA, see Appendix A for medal positioning. Dress uniforms are not to be worn while drinking excessive alcohol in public and if found to be doing so may result in disciplinary action being taken by the Brigade and/or the CoA.

~~g)~~**e) Brigade Shirts**

Brigade shirts are not to be worn while drinking alcohol in public and if found to be doing so may result in disciplinary action being taken by the Brigade and/or CoA.

13. ALCOHOL AND DRUG CONSUMPTION

PROCEDURE

a) Bush Fire Brigade personnel shall **NOT** respond to an incident or participate in any Bush Fire operation or activity if alcohol or drugs have been consumed; the CoA has a **zero alcohol and drug tolerance.**

b) Alcohol or drugs shall **NOT** be consumed by personnel whilst undertaking any task or function associated with incident response, suppression or recovery phases.

c) Alcohol or drugs shall **NOT** be consumed by personnel whilst engaged in training activities associated with operational tasks.

d) When driving, personnel must comply with Road Traffic Regulations.

Refer to CoA Fitness for Duty Policy **Appendix 2**

14. SMOKE AFFECTED ROADS

PROCEDURE

Fire burning on or near road verges, with smoke obscuring vision, is potentially the most dangerous situation volunteers can find themselves in. More fire fighters have been killed or injured in this situation than any other firefighting activity.

Treat traffic like electricity. Do not attempt to work in smoke reduced visibility until you are sure the flow has been cut off.

Extreme caution must be taken and the following procedures followed at all times:

Fire fighters working from or on a Gazetted roadway that is part of a fire ground (Roads will be closed under State Emergency Management Guidelines)

1. For the safety of fire fighters any roadway where fire fighters are working must be closed if there is a risk of injury or accident

2. Where possible fire fighters should look for alternative work environments other than the roadway.

If not possible park vehicle off the road a best as possible, use road cones or signs to identify hazard, make sure all warning lights are activated.

Gazetted roads under the Care and Control of the Local Government

If the Road is a Local road under the care of the CoA the Incident Controller will close the road. The CESC or Ranger shall arrange for the road to be attended to by appropriate qualified staff.

If police assistance is unavailable, and a detour is not possible, then the Road or Roads are to be closed when fire operations are being undertaken.

Gazetted roads under the Care and Control of Main Roads (MRWA)

If the Road is a major Highway or arterial road under the care of Main Roads, then Main Roads shall be contacted via the police to have the Road closed and signed accordingly.

The Incident Controller shall request MRWA to formulate and implement a Traffic Plan. The request shall be made via the DFES communication Centre or the Police

If police assistance is unavailable, and a detour is not possible, then the Road or Roads are to be closed when fire operations are being undertaken.

If a motorist "IGNORES" instructions from a duly authorised person then the offender's registration number and the time should be noted and reported to the police at the first opportunity.. The Incident Controller must be notified **by radio** immediately when a motorist disobeys any direction and proceeds.

Fire appliances **must** have all emergency lights on and headlights dipped when working in a visibility reduced hazard.

BRIGADE PERSONNEL HAVE A DUTY TO THEMSELVES AND THE TRAVELLING PUBLIC TO ENSURE THAT ALL OPERATIONS ARE PERFORMED WITH MAXIUM SAFETY.

15. ACCIDENT REPORTING

PROCEDURE

All accidents and near miss accidents must be reported.

a) All accidents and near misses on an operational fire ground must be reported to either the

- CBFCO
- DCBFCO
- FCO
- CESC
- Incident Controller
- Brigade Captain
- Officer in Charge

16. DECEASED PERSON / PRESERVATION OF SCENE

PROCEDURE

The Police have a requirement under the *Coroners Act 1996* and Police Routine Orders ***to view the body of a deceased person, in situ*** so that evidential information and forensic details may be obtained.

As a consequence, Brigade personnel are requested to assist the Police by strictly adhering to the following guidelines:

1 At any incident where death occurs the body is to remain in situ and the area immediately secured awaiting the arrival of the Police and Forensic Services.

2 Where the body is in a public place and visible by the public it should be screened if possible, place blanket over deceased person, barrier tape off large area and stop all persons entering site until Police arrive

In order that Brigade resources are not unduly placed on Standby for lengthy periods whilst awaiting the arrival of the Police, the Incident Controller is to request Police attendance as soon as possible after initial incident appraisal.

CRITICAL INCIDENT STRESS

Critical incident stress (CIS) is a reaction to a sudden, overwhelming, threatening or protracted event sufficient to overwhelm the usually effective coping skills of an individual. These events may cause an adverse psychological and/or physiological reaction, even in the most experienced person. These are normal reactions to abnormal situations.

CIS management aims to help workers deal with the normal physical and emotional reactions that may result from involvement in or exposure to critical incidents. Strategies include preparing workers for a possible critical incident, defusing (immediate support), debriefing (group support), and follow up support including one-on-one support sessions.

Preparation:

• Ensure positive work relationships and workplace morale
• Provide access to suitably trained internal and external debriefers
• Assess the workplace for potential critical incidents
• Develop procedures for responding to identified critical incidents, in consultation with workers
• Ensure workers are familiar with critical incident procedures through training, induction and briefings
• Provide opportunities (eg daily debrief) to assess workers for stress symptoms or abnormal behaviour

Defusing:

Conducted by a trained staff member immediately after the event to conclude it, provide immediate personal support, and may cover:

• Review of event
• Reassurance that their feelings are normal
• Clarification of questions and concerns
• Identify current needs
• Advice, information and handouts (referrals and support agencies)
• Contacts if they wish to talk
• Arrangements for debrief and other follow up sessions

Debriefing:

Debriefings are usually conducted within 72 hours of the event, when workers have had enough time to take in the experience. It is a structured voluntary discussion aimed at putting an abnormal event into perspective and assists them to establish a process to recovery.

Trained debriefers assist workers explore and understand a range of issues, including:

• The sequence of events, causes and consequences
• Each person's experience
• Any memories triggered by the incident
• Normal reactions to critical incidents
• Methods to manage emotional and physical responses resulting from a critical incident

Follow up support

Follow up with workers is usually conducted within a week of the debriefing session. Stress responses can develop over time and some workers or groups may require follow-up support, such as counselling. Employee Assistance Programs are available to provide counselling if required.

Where to get help

- Your supervisor or manager
- Safety officer/advisor
- Health and Safety Unit in your workplace
- Your doctor

Further information

- Workplace Assistance Program information – available in your workplace

17. STRIKE TEAMS / TASK FORCES

During the fire season, the Volunteer Brigades may be requested to provide a Strike Team/Task Force as support for other Fire Brigades or Local Governments.

A Strike Team is a set number of resources of the same type that have an established minimum number of personnel. Strike Teams always have a leader (usually in a separate vehicle), and have a common communications system. Strike teams are usually made up of five resources of the same type such as, vehicles, crews or earth moving machinery.

A Task Force is a combination of resources that can be assembled for specific purpose. Task forces always have a leader (usually in a separate vehicle), and have a common communications system. Task Forces are established to meet tactical needs and may incorporate a mix of different resources.

Strike Team and Task Force Leaders are responsible for ensuring that duties allocated to their Strike Team or Task Force are carried out efficiently.

Strike Teams/Task Forces are always in addition to normal duty crews and are on standby from 0900hrs to 0600hrs the following day (or as advised) and may be required when fire ratings are announced as Very High, Severe, Extreme or Catastrophic.

Strike Team/Task Forces when established, will turn-out to fires outside of the CoA gazetted fire area. Crews will remain in the CoA to cover their duty areas.

In the case of no Strike Teams (i.e. Moderate to High fire danger rating) day crews will turn out to fires outside of the CoA's gazette fire area; alternate crews will be sourced by fire base to cover the duty area.

Strike Teams when established, will automatically turn out to fires within the CoA as support to day crews. If Strike Teams are already committed to a fire within the CoA, alternate crews will be sourced by fire management to cover out of area fires if resources are available.

If first arriving crews to fires within the CoA deem that the fire will be handled easily by the day crews only, they are to stand down the Strike Teams so they are available for out of area fires.
All volunteers must have at least 12 months active firefighting experience to be considered for deployment within the State.

18. DEPLOYMENT

On occasion COA brigades may be required to deploy to incidents outside their normal operational duties (i.e. as a task force or strike team). These requests are usually as a result of depleted resources at an out of area incident. The other is when a request has come from DFES to have crews available for immediate deployment to a new incident. In either case, crews may deploy with or without an appliance depending on incident requirements or location.

COA Fire Crews are to adopt the following process for out of area deployment:

Brigade Preparation

- Each brigade will be contacted by either Chief or deputy with the request/details.
- Each crew member needs to be available for a minimum of 12-14 hrs shifts (or days requested – long deployment) and have the availability to stay in overnight accommodation if required.
- Crew members need to take a small person kit with them on deployment. It should contain, toiletries, change of clothes, spare shoes (non-fire), any medications, money, and any other personal affects (needs to be able to fit in gear bag).
- Each crew member needs to take their gear bag with full PPE kit.
- Chief or Deputy need to be promptly informed should a deployment crew not be available.
- At least one first aider needs to be on each crew.
- Brigades are to manage their own relief (SES can be used for transport) – the request for relief will come via the CBFCO or Deputy on advisement from DFES).
- One experienced officer per crew.
- A minimum of 2 qualified emergency drivers required for each appliance deployed.

Deployment with Appliance

- Usually for immediate assistance (Strike Team or Task Force)
- To proceed directly to staging point
- Extra drinking water and food each to be added to each appliance.

Deployment without Appliance

- Usually for regional crew relief – transport via bus or flight
- Crew members may be required to wear dress uniform or neat causal clothing with brigade t-shirt/polo shirt

Reference: DFES Directive 2.4 – Operational Deployment

19. BACK BURNING DURING BUSHFIRE INCIDENTS

INTRODUCTION

In the right circumstances back burning can be an effective technique to stop the spread of bushfires or protect assets during emergency situations.
Back burning must be done under correct conditions and carried out by experienced personnel on the fire ground otherwise it may create dangerous fire behaviour or increase the size of the current fire.

Some reasons for conducting back burns: -

- Asset protection
- Inaccessible country to fight the fire in traditional means
- Unexploded Ordnance known areas
- Squaring up fire boundaries
- Burning out to firebreaks

Commented [NP14]: Definition

PROCEDURE

- All techniques of fire suppression must be explored to suppress the fire before the choice is made to conduct a back burn
- A risk assessment shall be considered prior to the all-clear given for any back burn to be conducted
- Weather readings may be taken prior to any back burn been conducted
- **ONLY** the Incident Controller can give permission to carry out this task
- All personnel shall record the proceedings of the back burn in the personal fire diary.

NOTE: There is a difference between back burning and burning out pockets, permission shall still be sought from the Incident Controller if burning out pockets is required, **REMEMBER IT IS AN OFFENCE TO LIGHT A FIRE WITHOUT THE INCIDENT CONTROLLERS APPROVAL**.

20. CONTROLLED BURNS

Intermittently the Brigade undertakes controlled hazard reduction burning, normally in the cooler months. Probationary members are required to attend these burns as the hours spent contribute to probation periods.
As per the CoA Hazard Reduction Burn practices which includes prescriptions and fire permits

Commented [NP15]: How is their probation set? Is it a set twelve months or does it go on hours? No a maximum of 12 months, by doing things like this could/should improve their skills sooner to become a firefighter

21. COMMUNITY SERVICE

Occasionally the Brigade undertakes other duties as part of our commitment to the Community and the Local Council. This may take the form of providing a display at an event or show/fair, providing members to control car parking or other activities as approved by the Brigade and the CoA. All members are encouraged to attend these events.

22. WORKING WITH CHILDREN CHECK

The *Working with Children (Criminal Record Checking) Act 2004* aims to protect children from harm by introducing a high standard of compulsory national criminal record checking for people wishing to carry out paid, unpaid or volunteer work with children in Western Australia.

The Brigade Captain, CBFCO or Cadet Coordinator may request members to submit an application.

It is compulsory for Cadet Leaders to be current holders of a Working with Children card.

23. MEDIA

Clause 7.7(b) of the CoA Code of Conduct requires that all aspects of communication by staff

(including verbal, written or personal), involving the CoA's activities reflect the standards and objectives of the CoA. Communications should be accurate, polite and professional.
Any information for release to the media or public must be forwarded through the CoA's Communications Manager and approved by the Chief Executive Officer. Statements to the press on behalf of the City shall be made by the Mayor or the CEO only.
The CoA Communications Manager will be the designated Media & Public Affairs Officer for the CoA.
However the CBFCO may make statements to the media or public on behalf of the CoA regarding operational matters.

24. GENERAL INFORMATION

Visitors to the brigade's station are welcome, including children. Persons are to be reminded that the Brigade is a working environment and that it is the parent's responsibility to care for their child whilst in the area.

APPENDIX A

CoA
Fire Services Uniform Positioning of Medals and Accoutrements



A. Top of name badge is level with bottom of stitching at top of pocket and central to pocket

B. Bottom of badges are 1cm above top of pocket and inside edge of badge is in line with outside of centre pocket strip (Black vertical lines represent centre strip).
****** If only one badge is being worn it is to be in line with the centre of the pocket 1cm above top of pocket.

C. Medals are to be worn centre of pocket with the top of medal ribbon level with top of pocket

APPENDIX B

City of Armadale - HR Corporate Procedures – Fitness for Duty

HR CORPORATE PROCEDURES
FITNESS FOR DUTY

Date Adopted: 14 January 2013
Date Amended/Reviewed: July 2017
Next Review: May 2019
Responsible Officer: Human Resources Manager
Authorised: Chief Executive Officer

1. Purpose and Introduction

This procedure is designed to ensure that everyone working or present at a City of Armadale workplace is fit and capable of undertaking the tasks required of them with minimal risk. Persons who are not fit for duty may present a safety hazard to themselves and others.
This procedure applies to everyone working at, or attending a City of Armadale workplace. All persons shall comply with this procedure as a condition of their engagement. Restriction of duties where City of Armadale considers a person's fitness would impose an unacceptable risk may result from:

- work related injury or illness;
- non work-related injury or illness
- fatigue;
- physical or mental deterioration or disability;
- influence of alcohol or prescribed/non prescribed drugs; and
- other impediments to perform duties

2. Overview of Fitness for Duty Procedure

The following general guidelines are provided to assist all parties to resolve concerns about an individual's fitness for duty in a cooperative and constructive manner.
Elements of the Fitness for Duty Procedure include

- Identification
- Consultation
- Medical Assessment
- Implementing Outcomes

3. Identification

Supervisors or Managers, during the course of normal employment, may become aware of, or suspect that an Employee has a medical issue that is impacting on ability to perform in their role. These issues can include

- work related injury or illness;
- non work-related injury or illness
- fatigue;
- physical or mental deterioration or disability;
- influence of alcohol or prescribed/non prescribed drugs; and
- other impediments to perform duties

It is their responsibility to invoke this procedure.

Duty of the Employee to Obtain Assistance

Employees are required to seek assistance if they become aware of, or suspect that they have, a condition that could impair their fitness for duty.

4. Consultation

Once it has become evident or suspected that an individual's fitness for duty could be impaired, the individual concerned will be given the opportunity to discuss the matter in confidence with their manager or the Workplace Health & Safety Coordinator (WHS Coordinator). Individuals will have the right, if they wish, to be accompanied at any discussion by a work colleague, family member or health and safety representative.

5. Medical Assessment

The purpose of medical assessments is to determine if there is any medical reason the employee cannot perform the job or task under the working conditions.
Medical Assessments are also required when the employer wishes to be sure an employee can safely perform a specific job or task. Fit for duty assessments are most often done to determine medical fitness after a period of illness or injury, prior to employment or as a condition of a job transfer.
The employee will visit a medical professional who will determine if the person is able to perform a particular job. They may consider physical or mental capabilities, sensory acuity, level of skill, etc. The medical professional will typically only report one of three conditions back to the employer:

1. fit,
2. unfit, or
3. fit subject to work restrictions, modifications

There may be legitimate medical or other reasons for impairment of an individual's fitness for duty. In such circumstances, employees will be required to have their doctor discuss their circumstances with the WHS Coordinator before they are permitted to return to work.

Provision of Suitable Duties

Suitable duties are to be provided by the City of Armadale where it is reasonably practical to do so, on a temporary basis only. The provision of suitable duties to employees with non-work related injuries is undertaken with the expectation the employee will return to full and normal duties.
Suitable duties will be for a limited period, monitored closely. On occasions where it is not reasonably practical to provide suitable duties for an injured employee as determined by the WHS Coordinator and the injured employee's supervisor, the injured employee is to be advised immediately. Where it is medically identified that the employee will be unable to resume their full pre-injury duties, consultation regarding the City of Armadale's ability to provide alternate duties will be evaluated on a case by case basis and will include the following considerations: -

i) The range of activities the injured employee is capable of performing;
ii) The abilities and expertise of the injured employee;
iii) The availability of positions matching i) and ii).

No Return to Work – Certain Medical Conditions

If an individual has been requested to seek medical assessment, or where a manager, supervisor or other person in the work place has reasonable grounds to believe that the Fitness for Duty of an individual may be affected by physical or mental illness, injury, stress, fatigue or any other condition, the individual will not be permitted to return to work until they have been appropriately assessed and cleared for return to work under procedures acceptable by a medical professional.

Positive Drug or Alcohol Reading

If an employee is deemed unfit for duty as a result of a positive alcohol or drug test, they will not be permitted to return to work until such time as they have obtained a Medical Certificate which demonstrates that they are fit for duty.

Limitation of City of Armadale Involvement in Issues of Legitimate Concern

An individual's personal problems or behaviour outside work are private matters. The City of Armadale will only become involved when these have the potential to interfere with job performance and / or safety in the workplace, or where an employee requests assistance in dealing with an issue or where an individual's behaviours in the workplace may warrant intervention.

Serious Misconduct
A serious misconduct in relation to Fitness for Duty can occur where an individual:
- breaches the conditions of an existing management plan
- is involved in behaviour deemed as serious misconduct in the workplace
- places themselves or others in the workplace at serious risk of injury

In these circumstances, the individual will be subjected to discipline procedures which may result in the termination of employment of the individual, or a withdrawal of site access.

Discipline Procedures
A breach of this Fitness for Duty Procedure, or a Fitness for Duty Case Management Plan which has been put in place for an individual, may have disciplinary consequences. Discipline will be in accordance with City of Armadale HR policies, standards and procedures.

6. Implementing The Medical Advice
Options for managing the health related issue are listed below and will depend on the outcome of the assessment.

Personal Leave
The assessment may recommend that the employee be absent from work on sick leave for a specified period. This may be to allow the employee time to recover or meet certain health targets. A further medical assessment may be required to determine how the return to work is to be managed and when it can safely occur.

Return to normal duties
A further medical assessment may be required to determine how the return to work is to be managed and when it can safely occur. The assessment may recommend that the employee return to their normal position work, but it may require reasonable workplace adjustment.

Workplace Adjustments
The City of Armadale will provide the nominated medical assessor factual information on the physical environment of the workplace, the operational requirements of the work unit and any other unique characteristics of the workplace that the medical assessor should be aware of in making any recommendations on workplace adjustments.

Alternative Duties
Another type of workplace adjustment is alternative duties whether on a temporary or permanent basis.
Where the medical advice states that an employee could fulfil alternative duties.
A transfer may be considered when:
- it is not possible to offer suitable employment within the same department
- the employing department cannot retrain the employee
- it is not possible to redesign the position in order to provide them with meaningful work at their pre-injury/illness level of employment.

Medical Retirement
The nominated medical provider may assess that the employee has long-term health issues affecting their ability to safely continue in their position or fulfil the inherent requirements of their position, or the employee's incapacity appears likely to be permanent.
In this case the CEO or delegate is to decide whether an employee is to be medically retired. This decision should happen on receipt of the advice and following the expiry of any review period. Before deciding, the CEO or delegate must:

- be satisfied that the elements set out in the relevant legislation and policy have been met
- be clear on the medical basis on which the proposed medical retirement will be based
- be satisfied that the proposed medical retirement is the last resort and the employee is genuinely unable to carry out the full inherent requirements and demands of the position
- be satisfied that reasonable attempts have been unsuccessful in identifying duties commensurate with identified medical restrictions, and there are no suitable alternative positions in which the employee can be placed.

7. Guidelines for Supervisors

Identification
The supervisor who receives reliable information that an employee may be unfit for duty, or through personal observation believes an employee to be unfit for duty, will validate and document the information or observations as soon as is practicable.
Actions that may trigger the need to evaluate an employee's fitness for duty include, but are not limited to, problems with dexterity, coordination, concentration, memory, alertness, vision, speech, inappropriate interactions with co-workers or supervisors, inappropriate reactions to criticism, or suicidal or threatening statements.
The WHS Coordinator is to be contacted immediately should the supervisor observe or should the employee inform the supervisor of any of the following:

- work related injury or illness;
- non work-related injury or illness
- fatigue;
- physical or mental deterioration or disability;
- influence of alcohol or prescribed/non prescribed drugs; and
- other impediments to perform duties

Consultation
The supervisor will present the information or observations to the employee at the earliest possible time in order to validate them; and will allow the employee to explain his or her actions, or to correct any mistakes of fact contained in the description of those actions. The supervisor is then to contact the WHS Coordinator who will determine whether the employee should leave the workplace immediately for safety reasons.
In situations where there is a basis to think that an offence may have been committed and/or the employee is making threats to harm himself or herself or others, or is acting in a manner that is immediately dangerous to himself or herself or others, the supervisor shall contact the WHS Coordinator and/or Human Resources Manager regarding the fitness for duty procedure after the immediate safety issue has been addressed.
For situations arising outside the 8:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m. workday, the supervisor/manager will make a determination of whether the employee should leave the workplace immediately for safety reasons. The WHS Coordinator should then be contacted at the beginning of the next business day.
Based on the descriptions provided by the supervisor, WHS Coordinator will determine whether a fitness for duty evaluation is required and, if so, the type of evaluation needed and the type of health service provider to make the evaluation. Human Resource (HR) may also be consulted to aid in determining the type of leave to be used pending a complete assessment of the situation.

Medical Assessment
WHS Coordinator will provide a form for the designated health service provider for completion to certify whether the employee is fit to return to work. The health service provider form will include a behavioural description of the circumstances leading to the request for evaluation, and a list of the employee's relevant duties (Position Job Dictionary). The WHS Coordinator may facilitate communication with the health service provider as necessary on consent by the employee.
The employee will generally be responsible for the cost of medical expenses. The City will cover the cost of the fitness for duty evaluation and other medical investigations.

Based on information provided by the health service provider, the WHS Coordinator will advise the supervisor whether the employee should return to work and, if so, the conditions of return, including whether the employee must attend a re-entry conference with the supervisor and WHS Coordinator, and whether additional follow-up meetings are necessary. The final decision on whether a provider's certification will be accepted lies with the employee's departmental management. A second independent health service provider certification may be requested in some cases. The employer will be responsible for the cost of the second independent provider's certification.
The employee must comply with all aspects of the fitness for duty and evaluation procedures, including furnishing necessary consent and release forms to the health service provider. Noncompliance may be grounds for disciplinary action up to and including termination.
Information will be requested from the health service provider regarding work restrictions that may be required upon the employee's return to work.
Application of this policy is not intended as a substitute for other City of Armadale policies or procedures related to performance; nor are it intended as a substitute for discipline. Situations involving violations of City of Armadale policies or practices may result in disciplinary action being taken.

8. Guidelines For Workplace Health & Safety Coordinator

Identification
The WHS Coordinator will discuss the issue with the employee and the supervisor. They will determine if a Medical Assessment is required.
If it is determined that a medical assessment is required the employee will not be permitted to resume work until such time as they have attended a medical assessment and are deemed fit for duty.

MEDICAL ASSESSMENT

General basis for referrals
The City of Armadale may need to seek medical advice on how to safely manage a health related issue that is affecting an employee's ability to perform the inherent requirements and demands of the position for which they were engaged. Any advice sought must be in accordance with:

- the overriding legislative responsibility under the *Occupational Health and Safety Act 1984* for the City of Armadale to manage risk and ensure the health, safety and welfare at work of employees; and
- a Chief Executive Officer's responsibilities and functions for ensuring the effective, efficient and economical management of their agency.

The type of medical advice requested may relate to an employee's:

- ability to safely carry out the inherent requirements and demands of the position for which they were employed, in the short or long term
- medical restrictions that may apply in the workplace
- temporary or permanent adjustments that may need to be made in order to facilitate a safe return to work or to remain safely on duty
- safe return to work

It may also become necessary to seek medical advice relating to:

- whether a medical condition has contributed to a conduct or performance issue
- whether a second opinion is required, for example, in respect of advice from an employee's medical practitioner which seems inconsistent with other available evidence
- any impact the health of the employee may have on the health and safety of other employees in the workplace, or on non-employees, for example visitors or clients .

Employee initiated Medical Retirement

Where an employee who is suffering a non-work related injury or health condition requests an independent medical assessment with the view of accessing medical retirement benefits the City of Armadale may rely on the employee's treating doctor's advice supporting medical retirement.

Employee's treating doctor
In the first instance the City of Armadale must rely on the available medical advice from the employee's treating doctor in relation to the doctor's assessment of their capacity for work. Additional advice may be sought by the City of Armadale where it is unclear or there are concerns about the practicality of implementing the doctor's advice. The City of Armadale should discuss this with the employee first, and then, request additional information or clarification from the employee's treating doctor.
The City of Armadale will obtain a signed general consent from the employee to enable appropriate advice to be sought from the employee's medical practitioners (the *Authority to Release Medical Information* Form).
All requests for employees to attend their treating doctor must be consistent with the *"Referral of Employees"* section in this document. The City of Armadale is to provide the treating doctor with a contact name and phone number of an appropriate person in the City of Armadale who will be available to be contacted in case clarification is required of the questions being asked.
If the information is not made available from the employee's treating doctor or is inconsistent with other available evidence, or inadequate, or would result in an unreasonable delay, then the City of Armadale may seek independent medical advice from the nominated medical assessor. (It should be noted that appointments with specialists may take time, depending on the availability of the specialist).

Direction to cease duty - allocation of leave pending medical assessment
For staff employed at the City of Armadale, if a direction has been given to an employee to cease duty pending a medical assessment, the employee will be directed to take personal leave. Following the medical assessment, should the employee be deemed unfit and the nominated medical assessor advises that sick leave is appropriate, then sick leave is to apply from when the employee was directed to cease duty.

Direction to attend a medical assessment
Whether a referral for a medical assessment is under a City of Armadale general OH&S obligations or other specific provision, employees are required to comply with reasonable direction to attend **and participate** in a medical assessment. Employees should remain aware that if they fail to comply with such a reasonable direction they may be subject to disciplinary procedures**.**
Reasonable steps should be taken to check that an employee is capable of attending a medical assessment.

Nominated Medical Assessor
The City of Armadale may elect to use the nominated medical assessor but are not required to do so and may use another appropriately qualified medical provider to undertake independent medical assessments of employees.

Referral of Employees
The City of Armadale will provide objective, accurate and relevant information to the employee's treating doctor or nominated medical assessor. The minimum standards listed below apply to all referrals.

Referrals to a nominated medical assessor
A nominated medical assessor may require referral information in a standard format, in addition to the written report.

Referrals to be made by a duly authorised person
The CEO or a specifically authorised delegate, such as, the WHS Coordinator or Human Resources Manager, must authorise all referrals and sign the written report.

WRITTEN REPORT
A written report that contains all of the following information must always accompany a referral:

1. **Basis for referral** -

2. **Inherent requirements** and **demands of the position** - information which documents the inherent requirements and demands of a position and the work performed including both items below:

- Position Job Dictionary: a description of the common tasks performed, any tools and technologies commonly used and the work environment (e.g. outdoor work)
- Position Description: the knowledge, skills, abilities and other characteristics required which are commonly contained in a position description.

3. **Outline the health-related issue(s) that is/are affecting the ability to perform the inherent requirement/s and demands of the position** - and refrain from making any assumptions about a medical condition in the absence of a diagnosis from a qualified medical practitioner.

4. **How the injury or health condition is affecting the ability to perform the inherent requirement/s and demands of the position** - Reports should be based on factual information on how work performance relating to the inherent requirement/s of the position is being affected by the injury or health related condition provided by the employee's immediate supervisor.

5. **Specific question(s)** – state the workplace specific question(s) that require an answer from the medical provider. Unless clinical advice is particularly being sought on an employee's ability to safely continue in a particular job, it is not sufficient to simply request an assessment of an employee's "fitness to continue" or assume the question(s) will be inferred from the general background. If clinical advice is being sought on an employee's ability to continue in a particular job or to undertake alternative employment this must be made clear in the referral.

6. **Previous referrals** - detail any previous referrals and the outcome of any action to implement the previous advice. This must include copies of employee's treating doctor reports where provided and where the employee has consented to their inclusion. If a treating doctor report has not been made available this should be noted in the report for the assessor's information.

7. **Workers compensation** – include a statement that this referral**,** in so far as the workplace understands, is only related to a non-work related health issue and should it be identified that the health issue is related to an employee's compensable health matter then the referring workplace should be contacted immediately.

8. **Summary of documents** – a summary of the documents in checklist format.

Referrals must be based on health related issues
It is not the role of the nominated medical assessor to undertake medical assessments arising from non health related matters that must be managed by the workplace.
There may be occasions where a workplace seeks medical advice to confirm it is safe for an employee to be involved in a complaints resolution, performance management or disciplinary process. In providing contextual information for a referral, it is only necessary to provide relevant details of the discipline, investigation or performance appraisal process, unless those details are prevented from being disclosed due to confidentiality requirements. Any information provided must not pre-empt the outcome of the process and allegations or complaints should not be brought to the employee's attention for the first time as a result of the referral.

Security and confidentiality of documentation

City of Armadale must ensure that all referral records are secure against loss, unauthorised access, modification or other misuse.

Employee to be consulted and provided with copies of documentation
The employee must be made aware of the reason for the referral and where possible, in person (particularly if their ability to continue in a particular job is raised).

City of Armadale will provide the employee with copies of all information sent to the nominated medical assessor.
Employees may be accompanied by a support person **at the medical assessment**. This may be a union representative.
When copies of referral documents are sent to the employee they must be accompanied by a form requiring the employee to sign and return to the agency acknowledging receipt of the documentation**.** If this acknowledgement cannot be made or is not received, the agency should make reasonable attempts to contact the employee to confirm receipt. Any lack of formal acknowledgement is not an indication that the employee has not received the documentation and this should not delay the assessment process. However, the City of Armadale should notify the nominated medical assessor of the lack of acknowledgement.

Employee may provide information
Employees have the right to send a written response to the nominated medical assessor about the information in the agency's referral. Any such response must be relevant and confined to the same health-related issues contained in the referral.
Employees should ensure the nominated medical assessor is provided with any additional **medical information** not contained within the referral **at the earliest possible opportunity and no later than the day of the appointment**.

Employees are strongly encouraged to provide the additional information to the City of Armadale to ensure that any future decisions are based on all relevant information. To this end employees may need to consider the balance between their desire for confidentiality and the need for the agency to have sufficient information to ensure that the agency can provide a safe place of work for the employee, to enable appropriate support to be offered and to address any specific workplace issues affecting the employee.

Employee consent form
The City of Armadale will make available to the employee at the time of referral the *Authority to Release Medical Information* Form. The employee may sign the consent form at the time of referral or sign at a later date after discussing with their treating doctor or specialist as to what information should be made available to the employer to provide the best outcome for the rehabilitation of the employee.

Supplementary information
The City of Armadale may provide the nominated medical assessor with relevant supplementary information at any time following the initial referral.

Timeframes
The time taken to conduct a medical assessment and implement the advice will vary due to a range of factors including any of the following:

- whether the employee provides information or the agency provides supplementary information
- the time taken to get an appointment with a practitioner
- the number and complexity of the health issues
- the need to refer matters to specialists and the promptness in which reports from other practitioners are provided
- the emergence of additional issues as the assessment or implementation of the advice proceeds
- whether the employee has sought a review of the medical assessment or the time taken for the agency to be notified that an employee has not sought a review.

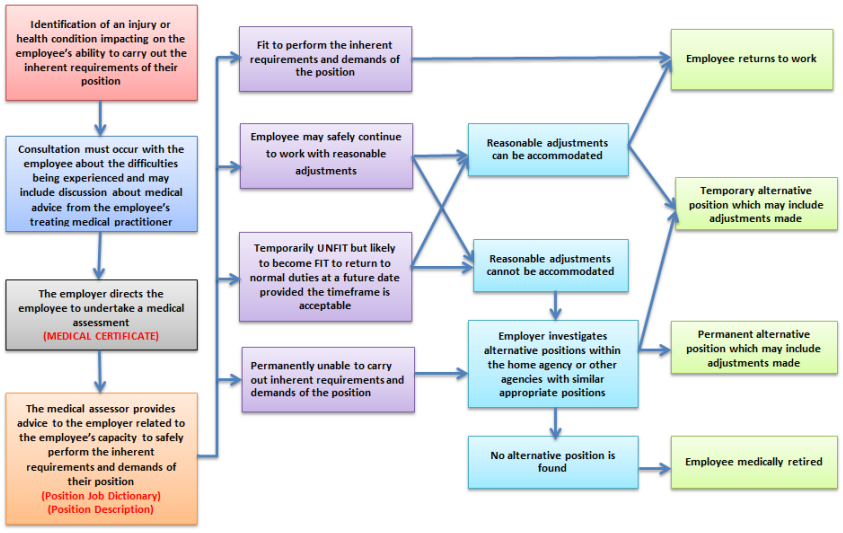
Employee Assistance Programs
An employee may feel anxious about the process and may require additional support. Managers should encourage employees to use the Employee Assistance Program (EAP) made available through their agency.
Separately from the EAP there are many community and general welfare support services that can be accessed by individuals.

THE MEDICAL ASSESSMENT
Following the medical examination, the nominated medical assessor will provide a report to the agency and the employee which sets out the basis for the advice.
The nominated medical assessor's advice may include any of the examples listed below depending on the reason for referral, the basis of the referral and the agency's specific question(s):

- fit to return to their normal position
- fit to return to their normal position with reasonable adjustments, restrictions and/or a rehabilitation program
- temporarily unfit but is likely to become fit to return to their normal duties within an approximate time frame or date.
- temporarily unfit but is likely to become fit to return to normal duties with reasonable adjustments or alternative duties within an approximate time frame or date.
- permanently unable to carry out the inherent requirements and demands of their position
- permanently unfit for any duties.

The nominated medical assessor may discuss the advice with the City of Armadale but it will be limited to health matters that relate to the employee's ability to safely undertake the inherent requirements and demands of the position and any rehabilitation or adjustment issues. The nominated medical assessor must not disclose any other health matters without the employee's written consent.

FITNESS FOR DUTIES FLOW CHART



APPENDIX C

Bush Fire Operating Procedure - Recruitment Program

overview

This operating procedure is to stipulate processes and accountabilities by The City of Armadale Fire Service for ensuring all new recruits are provided with the information, instruction and training to become a member in an efficient and competent manner.

1 SCOPE

The requirement of this procedure applies to all City of Armadale Fire Service Brigade new recruits and is subject to provisions outlined in this procedure.

2 REFERENCES

Bush Fire Service Membership Application Form

City of Armadale OH&S Induction

DFES Volunteer Firefighter Induction Sign-Off

DFES Course Application Form

City of Armadale Fire Services Policy Manual

City of Armadale Probationary Fire fighter Skill Log Book

3 DEFINITIONS and ABBREVIATIONS

Armadale Fire Service

ment of Fire and Emergency Services

ushfire Control Officer

: Fire fighter

ionary Fire fighter

nel Protective Clothing

4 ACTIONS

4.1 Potential New Recruit

The Recruitment Officer shall undertake an informal interview and provide the potential new recruit with a tour of the station, fire appliances, and details on how the brigades are structured and overall operations of the City of Armadale Fire Service.

During the first meeting the potential new recruit is to complete a membership form and provide a copy of a valid driver license.

Subsequent meeting with the potential new recruit is to be undertaken during the first available brigade training session and complete an Emergency Contact form.

All documentation is to be provided to the Recruitment Officer within two weeks of attending subsequent meeting/session as follows:

- Bush Fire Service Membership Application Form
- Valid Driver Licence (if driving appliances)
- Volunteer National Police Check – If required

- Medical Assessment – If required
- Other Relevant Certificates (i.e. First Aid)

The Brigade Captain shall be responsible for maintaining all potential new recruit personnel details, a file shall be established and contain a copy of a driver licence, relevant certificates and qualifications including the completion of the Membership Form.
Upon the successful completion of the above process and the satisfaction of the Brigade Captain can appoint the new recruit as a RFF.
A copy of the approved Membership Form shall be forwarded to the CBFCO.

4.2 Recruit Fire Fighter

4.2.1 Induction

The Captain in consultation with the Brigade Training Officer shall ensure and arrange all RFFs undertake and complete the following mandatory training sessions before attending the Bush Fire Fighting Course:

- City of Armadale OH&S Induction
- The Dead Man Zone Video
- The Burnover Blanket Use (CCP Video)
- DFES Volunteer Firefighter Induction Sign-Off

All RFF training sessions shall be carried out at brigade level and recorded in the RFFs personnel file.
The Brigade Captain shall provide a copy of the COAFS Policy Manual to all new RFFs.

4.2.2 Equipment Issue

The Captain in consultation with the Brigade Equipment Officer shall ensure and arrange all RFFs are issued spare (temporary) PPC and equipment to cover scheduled Bush Fire Fighting course.

4.2.3 Nomination Form

Upon the completion of items 4.2.1 – 4.2.3 inclusive, the Brigade Training Officer shall arrange with the recruit access to DFES eAcademy and help them nominate for introductory DFES bushfire courses.

4.3 Completion of Bush Fire Fighting Training Course

Captain shall provide the Brigade Secretary the membership details of the new RFF to be added to the brigade contact list and membership spreadsheet.

4.4 Probationary Firefighter

The Brigade Training Officer shall provide a Brigades Probationary Firefighter Skill Log Book to all new PFFs.
The Brigade Training Officer in consultation with the Brigade Captain shall be responsible for ensuring all PFFs are assigned with a brigade Mentor to ensure PFFs achieve all the appropriate competencies and technical experience during their probationary period.
Upon the successful completion of the COA Probationary Firefighter Skill Log Book and the satisfaction of the appointed Mentor, Brigade Training Officer and Brigade Captain, the PFF can be appointed a Firefighter.
Captain shall arrange and update the Brigade Email/Pager Call System of all those who attended and completed the course.

4.5 Issue of New PCC

Upon the completion of the COA Probationary Firefighter Skill Log Book and the successful completion of all relevant introductory DFES bushfire courses, the Brigade Equipment Officer will arrange the supply of new PPC to the PFF.

4.6 Firefighter

4.6.1 Firefighter Promotion

Following the successful completion of the Brigade Probationary Firefighter Skill Log Book and the probationary period review the probationary period will end.

During the next scheduled Brigade Monthly Meeting, Firefighter promotion will be announced by the Brigade Captain, a Certificate of Promotion and Helmet Firefighter stickers are presented.
Completed and approved Brigade Probationary Firefighter Skill Log Books are to be filed with the member's personnel records.

4.6.2 Update Brigade Membership List

The Brigade Captain shall provide Firefighter rank promotion details to Brigade Secretary to update and distribute the Brigade Membership list.

5 Revision Status

Revision	Description	Date
1.0	Introduction of a new Standard Operating Procedure	Sept 2018

APPENDIX D

Occupation:
Employer's Name:
Employer's Address:
Suburb: **Postcode:** **Telephone:**
Have you been convicted of any criminal or driving offences in the last 12 months?
NO YES DETAILS

DECLARATION:

I hereby declare that the above information is true and correct and if my application is accepted, I will agree to the following:

1. I will obtain a Volunteer National Police Clearance if requested;
2. *To promote the objectives of the brigade at all times;
3. *To be governed by the brigade Local Laws, Bush Fire Operating Procedures as may be amended from time to time;
4. *To use my best endeavours to give assistance when called upon, and at all times to obey orders and instructions given by authorized personnel of the brigade;
5. *I accept that my membership may be terminated at any time, if, at the discretion of the City of Armadale CEO, the CBFCO (or in his absence the DCBFCO), or the Captain, my actions or behaviour is considered not to be in the best interest of the brigade or council.
6. Do you have any medical conditions that may prevent you from completing you requirements as a volunteer firefighter?
7. I accept that I must attend 2 training sessions and 1 meeting per quarter to maintain currency within the brigade.

* *Delete as appropriate for Cadet Members.*

Signature: .....Date: / /

Agreement of parent or guardian : .....Date: / /

DRIVERS LICENCE
I have a current valid Manual Western Australian Motor Drivers Licence and hold the classes as stated below.
Licence Classes Licence Number
Expiry Date
Sighted by Captain/Training Officer

Application received by Chief	
Application sent to DFES	
Application approved	

APPENDIX E